

10 POWER MOVES

A practical cheat sheet for reading situations clearly, protecting your time, and acting with intention — translated from ideas made famous in *The 48 Laws of Power*.

BEFORE YOU START

This isn't about outplaying people.

Most content on power and strategy focuses on what to do to other people. This guide takes a different angle: self-mastery — reading a room accurately, protecting your energy, and not undermining yourself with impulsive words or actions.

Each of the ten ideas includes a short explanation, one small action for this week, and a question to sit with. You don't need all ten at once — pick one, try it for a week, and notice what shifts.

How to use this guide: read one page a day instead of all ten at once. The point isn't information — it's a small behavior change you can notice by Friday.

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SAY LESS THAN NECESSARY

Unfinished sentences carry more weight than full ones.

When you explain too much, you hand people more to question, doubt, or pick apart. Brevity reads as certainty. The more you over-explain a decision, the more it sounds like you're convincing yourself.

TRY THIS WEEK

Before you send a message explaining a decision, cut it in half. Notice if it still lands.

Where in your life do you over-explain out of anxiety rather than necessity?

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GUARD YOUR REPUTATION

Consistency is a form of power.

People extend trust based on pattern, not intention. One inconsistent moment doesn't erase years of reliability, but repeated small inconsistencies quietly erode it. Reputation is compounding interest — built slowly, spent quickly.

TRY THIS WEEK

Pick one small commitment you've been sloppy about (replying on time, showing up when you said you would) and hit it perfectly for seven days.

What's one small inconsistency you've let become a habit?

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WIN THROUGH ACTION, NOT ARGUMENT

Proof ends debates that words only extend.

Arguing to change someone's mind often entrenches them further — people defend positions they feel attacked on. A demonstrated result is harder to argue with than the best-worded case.

TRY THIS WEEK

Next time you feel the urge to argue your point in a group chat or meeting, hold it and instead deliver the result that proves it.

Is there a disagreement you're trying to win with words that action would settle faster?

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APPEAL TO SELF-INTEREST WHEN ASKING FOR HELP

“Can you help me” lands weaker than “here’s what’s in it for you.”

Most requests for help are framed around the asker's need. Reframing around what the other person gains — even something small like visibility, learning, or reciprocity — makes the request easier to say yes to.

TRY THIS WEEK

Before your next ask, rewrite the message to lead with what's in it for them, not what you need.

Do you tend to ask for help apologetically? What would asking confidently sound like?

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TURN WEAKNESS INTO LEVERAGE

Naming your limitation early can disarm it.

Hiding a weakness invites others to find and expose it on their terms. Naming it yourself, calmly and early, removes its power as a surprise and often earns more respect than pretending it doesn't exist.

TRY THIS WEEK

In one situation where you'd normally hide a gap, state it plainly and move on. Watch how the conversation continues.

What's one weakness you're spending energy concealing that people probably already suspect?

6

ENTER ACTION WITH BOLDNESS

Hesitation is more visible than mistakes.

A confidently made imperfect decision often reads better — and recovers faster — than a hesitant, half-committed one. Hesitation signals doubt to everyone watching, even when the underlying decision was sound.

TRY THIS WEEK

Pick one decision you've been sitting on. Set a 24-hour deadline and commit fully once you decide.

Where has half-commitment cost you more than a wrong decision would have?

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SET THE STANDARD FOR HOW YOU'RE TREATED

People calibrate to the standard you demonstrate, not the one you state.

Announcing your worth rarely works. Behaving as though your time and standards matter — consistently, without announcing it — is what actually shifts how people treat you.

TRY THIS WEEK

Identify one boundary you state but don't enforce. Enforce it once, without over-explaining.

Where do your actions contradict the standard you say you hold?



READ THE ROOM BEFORE YOU SPEAK YOUR MIND

Being right and being effective are different skills.

You can hold a strong internal opinion while choosing your moment and audience carefully. This isn't dishonesty — it's recognizing that timing and framing determine whether your point is actually heard.

TRY THIS WEEK

Before your next disagreement, pause and ask whether this is the right moment and audience — not whether you're right.

Have you ever been right but ineffective? What would effective have looked like?



DON'T TRY TO APPEAR FLAWLESS

Visible effort and an occasional flaw build trust; a flawless image invites suspicion.

People connect with realness, not perfection. A polished, gap-free image tends to make others feel distant or competitive rather than drawn in.

TRY THIS WEEK

Let one small imperfection be visible instead of editing it out — in a conversation, a piece of work, or something you post.

Where has trying to look flawless actually made people trust you less?

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STAY ADAPTABLE

Rigid strategies break; adaptable ones bend and hold.

Committing hard to one identity, plan, or approach makes you predictable and brittle when circumstances shift. Staying observant and willing to adjust is a strength, not a lack of conviction.

TRY THIS WEEK

Notice one plan you're defending out of stubbornness rather than because it's still working. Adjust it.

What's one belief about "who you are" that's actually just an old habit you've stopped questioning?

ONE LAST THING

Pick one. Not all ten.

The people who get value from a guide like this aren't the ones who read it once. They're the ones who pick a single idea, run it for a week, and let it become a habit before moving to the next.

- 1 Reread the ideas that made you pause.
- 2 Choose one "try this week" to act on today.
- 3 Revisit this guide in a month — pick a different one.



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More breakdowns like this, every week — psychology,
philosophy, and critical thinking made practical.

